

1. Popularity heat map ★★★★★

The problem. Social media has become one of the main ways young people discover places, but it's built for inspiration, not action. People save dozens of posts about restaurants, viewpoints, and hidden spots, and those saves pile up in folders they rarely reopen. The information is trapped inside videos rather than tied to a location, so when someone is actually free on a Saturday or standing in a new city, there's no easy way to answer "what's good near me right now?" The gap isn't a lack of ideas. It's the friction between seeing something cool and actually going.

Who has it. Gen Z and young millennials, especially college students and young professionals in cities, who use TikTok and Instagram as search engines for food, travel, and things to do. They're heavy savers and sharers, often sending posts to friends with "we need to go here" messages that never turn into plans.

Why they care. Free time is limited, and they want to spend it on experiences that feel worth it. Every weekend spent at the same default spots feels like a missed opportunity, and the guilt of an untouched save folder is a small but real frustration. There's also a social layer: going to the place everyone's talking about is part of the experience, and being the friend who knows where to go carries status.

2. The crowd-avoider (inverse heat map)★★

The problem. Virality creates its own problem. When a spot blows up online, the same content pushes thousands of people to the same place, often at the same times, and the quiet, beautiful experience in the video disappears. Travelers usually only learn how crowded a place is when they arrive, after they've already spent the time and money getting there. Meanwhile, great places that aren't trending stay invisible, because algorithms reward what's already popular. There's no good tool for finding places that are worth it *and* calm.

Who has it. Travelers who care more about the experience than checking a box: couples looking for a relaxed day, photographers who need a clear shot, people who find crowds stressful, and families who can't handle hour-long lines with kids. It also includes locals who want to enjoy their own city without fighting tourist traffic.

Why they care. Crowds directly undermine the reason they went. Long lines eat into limited trip time, packed spaces raise stress instead of lowering it, and the place feels less authentic when everyone is there for the same photo. For people already prone to travel anxiety, crowd uncertainty can make them skip outings entirely. Knowing a spot will be calm, or knowing the best time to go, turns a gamble into a confident plan.

How the two connect. These are two sides of the same problem: social media tells people *where* to go but not *whether it's a good time to go*. A single map that shows both what's heating

up and what's cooling down could serve both groups, and you could frame that as one product in your presentation.